



MARKETING LABS · POSITIONING & MARKETING MIX

Brand Positioning Map

See the market through your audience's eyes.

Interactive brand positioning and perceptual map for customer-perception research.

Includes: framework reference · guidance by Brand type · printable worksheet

Brand Positioning Map: reference

INTERACTIVE PERCEPTUAL-MAPPING PROTOTYPE

Map how customers perceive your brand and the alternatives they genuinely consider. Use two attributes that matter to purchase decisions—such as affordability and specialist expertise, or simplicity and capability—to reveal crowded positions, meaningful differentiation and potential opportunities to investigate.

An empty space is a research question, not automatically an opportunity. A blank area can signal unmet demand, but it can also reflect a trade-off customers do not value, a proposition that is difficult to deliver or missing competitors. Ground map positions in customer evidence and test any positioning hypothesis before investing.

Brand perception map

Select a point to inspect its evidence note and compare its perceived position with the wider competitive set.

Alternatives plotted

Your brand

Competitor

Substitute / adjacent option

Dashed border = own brand

LOWER PERCEIVED VALUE → HIGHER PERCEIVED VALUE

HIGHER PERCEIVED VALUE

LOWER PERCEIVED VALUE

LESS SPECIALISED

MORE SPECIALISED

CUSTOMER PERCEPTION

COMPETITIVE DENSITY

3 close perceived pairings detected. Proximity can indicate that customers see brands as similar on these attributes; test actual consideration and substitution behaviour.

POSITIONING OPPORTUNITY

Your brand currently sits at 72/100 horizontally and 74/100 vertically. Use this as a hypothesis: identify a meaningful target position, then test whether it is desirable, credible and deliverable.

EVIDENCE QUALITY

Every plotted alternative has an evidence note. Next, record source, audience segment, sample and date so the map remains interpretable over time.

How to use a positioning map

- Choose axes that genuinely influence purchase or choice in the category; common axes such as price and quality are only useful if customers use them.
- Include the full consideration set: direct rivals, emerging competitors, substitutes, internal alternatives and familiar workarounds.

- Ask customers—not only internal teams—to rate or discuss the brands. Surveys, interviews, review analysis, social listening and website user testing can complement one another.
- Keep segments separate when perception differs meaningfully by role, need, geography, experience level or buying context.
- Treat distance as a perception signal, not exact competitive truth. A two-axis map simplifies a much richer set of associations and trade-offs.
- Compare intended position with actual customer perception, then test whether a potential new position is valuable, credible, distinctive and operationally sustainable.

Guidance by Brand type

Your brand

Competitor

Substitute or adjacent alternative

Brand Positioning Map: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Brand, competitor or substitute

For example: Your brand, direct competitor or alternative solution

Evidence or perception note

Summarise the research evidence, assumptions or customer language behind this position.

Brand type

☐ Your brand ☐ Competitor ☐ Substitute or adjacent alternative

Horizontal axis: lower end

Horizontal axis: higher end

Vertical axis: lower end

Vertical axis: higher end

Horizontal perception score

0 100

Vertical perception score

0 100

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.